

M. Taha

22F 3277

BCS-4C

Short Questions

Q1:

The three advantages of database system over file-based system are:

1. **Data Redundancy:** means storing of same data multiple times in different files which leads to multiple effort and a lot of space is wasted in file-based system which is not the case in DBMS.
2. **Reduce data inconsistency:** due to data redundancy in file-based system, files that represent same data may be inconsistent and hard to manage as compared to DBMS.
3. **Providing Backup and Recovery:** A DBMS has the facility of recovering from hardware or ~~backup~~ software failure and it provides backup and recovers and restores the database if the system fails in between the transaction.

Q2:

The primary role of database management system is to efficiently and securely store, retrieve and update data information.

Data Manipulation i.e. insert, update, delete is done through query language. The access and process is done by sending queries and requests.

The DBMS also has to give protection to database from hardware or software failures and unauthorized access.

Q3:

Data model is collection of concepts to describe structure of database. It provides abstraction and constraints of the database. It is visualization before implementation.

It has three concepts; Entity, Attributes and Relationship.

- Entity is the real world concept that we will implement in database, i.e. student
- Attributes represents properties of entity, i.e. student name.
- Relationship between two or more entities such as there is registration relationship between student and courses.

Q4:

It can be defined as capacity to change the schema at only one level that it do not effect the program and we don't have to change the schema at higher level.

It provides abstraction and hides the details, which allows programmers to modify the definitions without affecting the program that use it.

There are two types of data independence.

- 1- Logical data independence: to expand, change constraints or reduce database without changing external schema.
- 2- Physical data independence: modifying physical scheme without changing conceptual schema.

Q5: - Database Administrators (DBA): The DBA are those who control and manages the database. They are responsible for authorizing access to database, monitoring the use of database, they also manage hardware and software resources and also maintaining the integrity and privacy of database and protect from security breaching.

- End Users: are the people who will access the database. They may need the database for updating or generating reports. The database is created for these users. End users can be engineers who need DBMS to implement their applications, stand alone user maintain personal databases, casual users have low level of interaction and uses application to access information

Q6: - DDL: It is data definition language. It helps to define the structure of the database. It's set of ~~set~~ commands that create, modify and delete the database structure.

Some ^{basic} commands are;

- CREATE: used to create a new database, table
- ALTER: used to modify tables, columns, datatypes and constraints
- DROP: used to delete column, table, database or constraints

- DML: It is data manipulation language to manipulate data in database. It's commands are;

- SELECT: used to read/retrieve data from one or more tables
- INSERT: used to add new record in table
- UPDATE: used to modify existing record from table
- DELETE: used to remove/delete record from table

Q7:

Data encapsulation is a concept of object oriented programming. It is a way to bundle the implementation details from the user of methods and data attributes and properties within a single unit. The unit is called object in OOP and entity in DBMS.

Tables can have different fields with different data types which are attributes of that object and a record is a single object.

Objects can be stored in database using object relational database.

Q8:

Data: known facts and figures that are raw is called data.

Example: 22F3277 is a data

Information: processed form of data ^{that is} with meaningful and has context is called information.

i.e. 22F-3277 is roll no of a student at FAST.

Knowledge: It is the understanding of the information.

i.e. It is roll no of student of 22 batch of Faisalabad campus is knowledge.

Meta data: It is data about data. It defines actual data.

The meta data is a catalog and describe structure of data. It defines the (constraints, datatypes, lengths, minimum value, should field be left empty or not etc.) of field of the database.

Q9:

Self describing data refers to type of data that includes meta data about it's format or structure. The metadata allows the data to be interpreted.

The self describing aspect allows to interpret and process the data with additional documentation.

Q10:

For this example 3 tier structure would be more preferable because it provide scalability and can be managed easily (changes to user interface can be made independently) and also it enhances security and provides flexibility.

LONG QUESTION

Q1:

The main purpose of 3 schema architecture is to separate use application from physical database.

1. **External Schema:** It represents the user's view of data. It defines how data is presented and accessed by each individual user. Each application may have different external schema. This allows user to interact with DBMS without understanding of complex level.

2- Conceptual Schema ~~Logical~~: It describes the structure of whole database for community users.

It hides the details of physical storage structure. Its main purpose is to describe entities, database types, relationships, It also describes user operations and constraints. It describes data model.

3- Internal level Schema

- It is low level structure of the Architecture.
- It represents the physical storage structure and organization. It gives complete details of the access paths.
- To improve performance and storage efficiency changes are made here.

Data Abstraction: Support:

- The three levels allow data abstraction by hiding details which are not necessary to be shown.
- It also hides details within different levels.
- Changes in one level do not affect the other levels. It supports independence b/w logical and physical aspect of database.

Q2:

2-tier:

In 2-tier there are two components, client and the server. The client directly communicates with server. It is easier to build. It runs slower.

- i) File sharing system: In basic file sharing system client's directly interacts with file server to perform basic operation like ~~read~~ read, write, share. Server handles storage.
- ii) App with local database: desktop application with local database where client interact directly with database.
- iii) Reservation System: for small business uses 2-tier where client ~~at~~ application directly interact with local database to make reservation.

3-tier:

In 3-tier there are three components: client, application server and database server. It is common for web application. It provides additional features as security, encryption, decryption.

- Online Banking System: user interact with app to access banking service. The application server manages process the transaction, and database server manage financial record data.
- Online Shopping System: clients browse through application the application server manages user authentication, order processing and database server holds product details and user profile.

- iii) Web-application: User interact with web platform, the ^{application} ~~authentication~~ server manages process and access server.

N-tier Architecture:

It extends 3-tier by introducing additional layers for improving scalability, flexibility and to maintain easily.

- i) Health care Information System: It can have extra layer such as laboratories or insurance provider.
- ii) Online Learning Management System: additional layers can be assessments; or video streaming.
- iii) Online Shopping (E-commerce): A shopping platform with additional ~~fe~~ layer as cart, product details. are implemented.

Q3: i) Command Line Interface:

It is text based based where user interacts with DBMS by typing commands. User can execute queries and manage data structures.

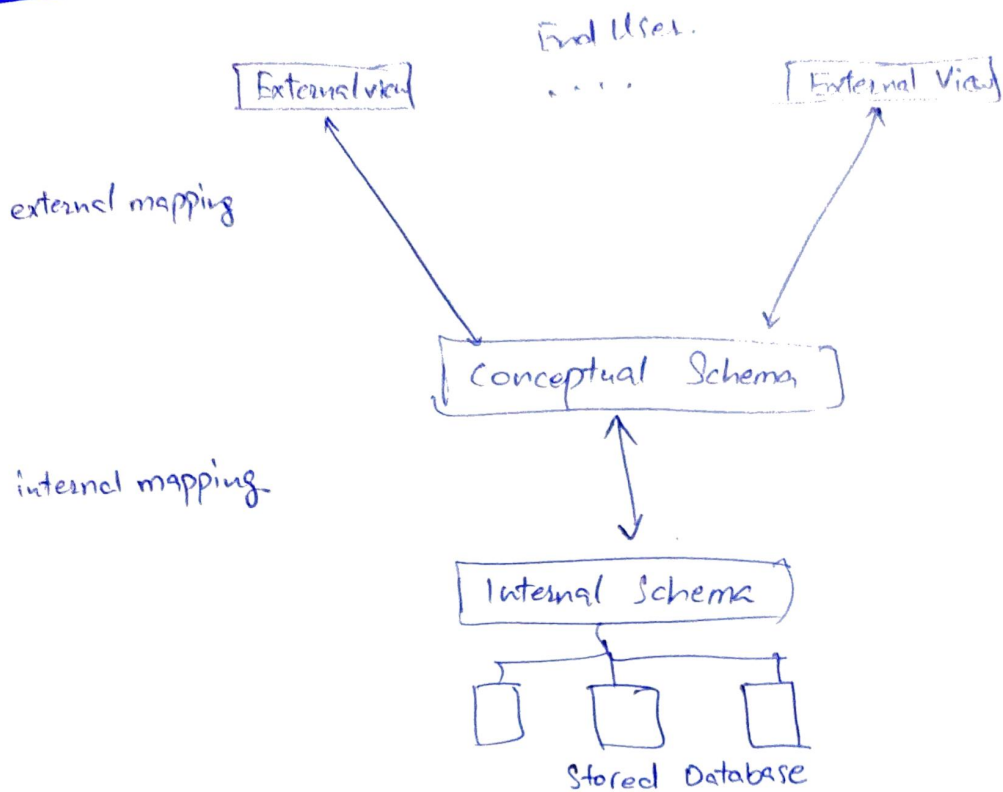
ii) Graphical User interface: It provide a visual interface and user can interact with buttons, menu and visual appealing ~~element~~ design making more use friendly.

iii) Web-based interface: Some DBMS offer web base access through web browser so that it can be accessed anywhere remotely. and are accessible from any device. The interface is user-friendly.

(iv) Application Programming Interface: An API provide set of functions that developers can use to integrate ~~to~~ database functionalities into their applications. It is common in web applications, mobile apps.

(v) Query Language Interface: It is standard language for interacting with relational database. ~~operation~~ Users developer, can use SQL commands to performs operation such as ~~query~~ updating, and managing the database.

Q4:



The internal schema is low level and is directly connected with database. It represents physical ~~store~~ storage structure and gives the details of access paths. Any changes made here are done to improve performance and storage efficiency. In conceptual schema it defines the ~~structure~~ entities, datatypes and relationships and constraints and hides internal schema details. The upper level is external view it is different for different users. It defines how data is accessed by each individual.

The DBMS transfers request from external schema to conceptual schema and from there to internal schema and the relevant data according to ~~the~~ user is then sent back. This process of transforming request and result between levels

are called mapping. Change in any level does not effect to change other level. It provides clear separation.

Q5: Data Independence.

It can be defined as the capacity to change the schema at only one level that it does not need to change the schema at next higher level. It provides abstraction and hide the details which allows the programmers to modify the definition without affecting the program.

There are two types of data independence.

- 1- Logical data independence: allows for changing conceptual schema without having to change external schema. We can change conceptual schema to expand change constraints or reduce database.
- 2- Physical data independence: it enables changes to physical schema without changing conceptual schema. It defines how the data is physically stored. and it access paths. changes made here can be done without impacting conceptual schema, by changing file structures to improve the performance of retrieval or update.